

THREE FINGERS

VISION. YOU STAND IN THE FOREST. THE YEAR
IS 9 AD. YOU ARE SOMEONE ELSE.

*Three fingers. Three Roman legions. We buried them in the
Teutoburg forest the year Romans call nine. We thought that was
the end of it.*

*Germanicus came back seven years later with fire. He burned every
longhouse between the Rhine and the Weser. He called us pacified.*

*My grandfather hung this shield here after Arminius died.
Murdered by his own family — Rome does not always need
soldiers. They offered gold to his brother. Let us do the rest.*

*The three fingers mean: we remember the legions we destroyed. We
also remember what it cost us.*

*The Cherusci do not exist anymore. Not as a people. There are men
with Cherusci blood, scattered, calling themselves Roman names.*

That is what three fingers cost us.

**Vision ends. Somewhere in the dark, the
torchlight dims.**